Muhammad Ariff Bin Abdul Razak

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WORK EXPERIENCE

SUTD – ROAR Lab
Research Assistant
Aug 2022 – May 2024 (Volunteer until Nov 2022, Full Time thereafter)

- Led the design of Panthera's intelligent lighting control system to signal the autonomous vehicle's intent to pedestrians and meet testing safety requirements, running a rosserial node on an Arduino under an RTOS that mapped cmd_vel, IMU, and vehicle-state topics to turn, warning, and hazard signals; the platform passed T1 autonomous testing at CETRAN.
- Wired and integrated the 3D LiDAR used for Panthera's obstacle detection, mapping, and localization, verifying sensor output through depth-map visualization, and supported the vehicle through its T1 autonomous field testing.
- Explored predictive safety for a stair-climbing robot by training and evaluating Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks on its sensor time-series data, showing that fall risk could be predicted.

Singapore Institute of Technology (SIT)
Student Research Engineer
Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Designed and built a temperature-controlled enclosure around a compression testing machine for faculty research on how foods behave during chewing, defining the electrical architecture and selecting components before handing the completed chamber over to the research team.
- Engineered closed-loop temperature control with a thermistor and standalone temperature controller, holding the chamber within ±2 °C of a 37 °C body-temperature setpoint for consistent test conditions.

KLASS Engineering and Solutions
Machine Learning & Fullstack Engineer (Intern)
Sep 2025 – Aug 2026

- Reproduced and benchmarked state-of-the-art AI-generated video and audio detectors (NSG-VD, D3, ReStraV, SpeechForensics) on SLURM-based HPC to assess detection capability against AI-generated media as a public-safety threat, achieving 90.03 AUROC on the NSG-VD replication.
- Ran ablation studies integrating optical flow (RAFT), segmentation (SAM 2), and point tracking (CoTracker) to test whether physical-motion signals in video sequences can distinguish AI-generated content, finding mixed evidence of a usable signal.
- Engineered a data generation pipeline chaining video extension (Wan2.2), voice cloning (Chatterbox), and lip-sync (LatentSync) models to curate a balanced 1,200-video real/fake dataset, used to compare all four detectors consistently and to test models at small scale before committing larger compute.
- Evaluated audio-visual synchronization as a deepfake detection signal, selecting a ~0.3 operating threshold through ROC analysis.
- Managed GPU-accelerated experimentation on shared SLURM clusters (NVIDIA H200 nodes) via Docker containers, running sanity-check protocols on custom validation splits that caught pipeline errors before committing to training and synthetic-deepfake generation runs of up to 5 hours each.
- Built React frontend components and FastAPI backend services with WebSockets for real-time streaming responses, deploying multi-model AI endpoints for a company-wide internal AI chatbot platform that gave staff a secure alternative to public AI tools, with search across internal documents.

EDUCATION

DigiPen Institute of Technology & SIT
Aug 2023 – May 2027

- B.Eng. Mechatronics Systems
- Relevant Coursework: Mechanics, Control Systems, Robotics, Embedded Systems, Machine Learning, Systems and Software Engineering

Ngee Ann Polytechnic
Sep 2022 – Sep 2023

- Specialist Diploma in Robotics Engineering (SGInnovate PowerX)
- Relevant Coursework: Autonomous Robot Navigation, Machine Learning/Deep Learning for Robotics, Computer Vision

Singapore Polytechnic
Apr 2017 – Sep 2020

- Diploma in Mechatronics and Robotics
- Relevant Coursework: Microcontroller Applications, PLCs, and Robotics Integration

PROJECTS

1. Capstone (MET4004) — Acoustic Noise Reduction for Drones
Project Lead, Software & Electronics (Sponsored by KLASS)
Aug 2026 – Apr 2027

- Leading a 3-person team to deliver a proof-of-concept quiet indoor drone for end user MHA to reduce acoustic detectability, targeting a 78 dBA ceiling at a 1 m reference during steady hover, 10-minute hover endurance, and a 370 mm square airframe envelope, with the project proposal approved.
- Owning the software and electronics workstream, selecting a low-noise propulsion stack of 5-inch injection-molded toroidal propellers, custom ducts with acoustic lining and serrated trailing edges, 1300 KV low-RPM motors, and AM32 ESC PWM frequency tuning to shift tonal whine into less perceptible bands.
- Specified the avionics and power architecture (Holybro Pixhawk 6C Mini, PM02 V2 power module, dedicated 150 A power distribution board), yielding a derated 3.3:1 thrust-to-weight ratio at 1,200 g all-up weight to preserve control headroom for manually piloted indoor flight.
- Designed the acoustic validation plan to the Von Karman Institute four-microphone methodology with TU Berlin distance normalization to a 1 m reference, to benchmark directly against HKUST's 90.52 dBA commercial quadcopter baseline and VKI's DJI Phantom 3 SE measurements.
- Specified psychoacoustic post-processing in Python (MoSQITo) under both Zwicker (ISO 532-1) and Moore–Glasberg (ISO 532-2) loudness standards to quantify perceived annoyance beyond raw sound-pressure level.

2. Autonomous Airport Trolley Return Robot (SIT–DigiPen Coursework)
Firmware & Perception

- Built LiDAR-based perception in C++ and ROS for a robot that autonomously returns airport trolleys, developing and integrating obstacle detection, SLAM mapping, and localization with IMU and wheel-odometry sensor fusion on an onboard computer, completing the final demo task.
- Developed RTOS firmware on an STM32F7 microcontroller with concurrent tasks for obstacle detection and joystick control, and a custom serial protocol linking it to ROS for reliable motor control.

3. Custom 3D Printer Development
2019

- Built a custom 3D printer from off-the-shelf modules as a personal project, extending Marlin firmware in C++ with auto bed levelling and filament runout detection, improving first-layer adhesion and print quality and reducing failed prints.

4. Panthera Autonomous Vehicle — Intelligent Lighting System
Aug 2022 – May 2024

- Led the design of Panthera's intelligent lighting control system to signal the autonomous vehicle's intent to pedestrians and meet testing safety requirements, running a rosserial node on an Arduino under an RTOS that mapped cmd_vel, IMU, and vehicle-state topics to turn, warning, and hazard signals; the platform passed T1 autonomous testing at CETRAN.

5. Body-Temperature Test Chamber for Food Chewing Research
Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Designed and built a temperature-controlled enclosure around a compression testing machine for faculty research on how foods behave during chewing, defining the electrical architecture and selecting components before handing the completed chamber over to the research team.
- Engineered closed-loop temperature control with a thermistor and standalone temperature controller, holding the chamber within ±2 °C of a 37 °C body-temperature setpoint for consistent test conditions.

SKILLS / COMPETENCIES

Robotics, UAV & Autonomous Systems: Embodied AI, ROS, SLAM (3D LiDAR), Perception, Sensor Fusion, Visual-Inertial Odometry (VIO), Autonomous Mobile Robots, Quadcopter Design, UAV Flight Testing, UAV Aeroacoustics, Acoustic Noise Reduction, PX4 Autopilot, ArduPilot, Pixhawk
Embedded, Hardware & Test: Embedded C / C++, RTOS, Microcontrollers (STM32, Arduino), PID Control, Closed-Loop IoT Control, PCB Design, Firmware Development, Hardware Prototyping, Experimental Design, Test & Validation
Engineering Data & Analysis: Applied Machine Learning, Predictive Modeling, Regression Analysis, Classification Models, Scikit-learn, Data Preprocessing, Model Evaluation & Validation, Time Series Analysis, Sensor Data Analysis, Fault Detection, Data Visualization, Data-driven Engineering Optimization, Industrial Automation (PLCs), Engineering Data Analysis & Interpretation, Data-driven Decision Making

AWARDS / ACHIEVEMENTS / CERTIFICATES

- MOE (Ministry of Education) Instructor Certification (Achieved at age 18) — Valid Oct 2018 – Oct 2026 (renewing)
- Google Crash Course on Python
- Google The Bits and Bytes of Computer Networking
- Coursera Machine Learning